

SIMPLE SENTENCES

Learn English Step by Step

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For beginner English learners

Present • Past • Future

Learn one simple idea in three tenses. Students can compare the same sentence and see how the tense changes.

Lesson 1: What is a Simple Sentence?

A simple sentence gives one complete idea. It normally has a subject and a verb, and it may also have a complement.

Basic pattern: Subject + Verb + Complement

Examples:

- I am happy.
- I am tired.
- She is my cousin.
- I am Ali.

Remember: Start with a capital letter and finish a sentence with a full stop (.).

Lesson 2: Category No. 1 — Same Sentence, Three Tenses

Read each row from left to right. Notice how the to-be verb changes.

Present	Past	Future
I am happy.	I was happy.	I will be happy.
I am tired.	I was tired.	I will be tired.
She is my cousin.	She was my cousin.	She will be my cousin.
Mother is at home.	Mother was at home.	Mother will be at home.
They are ready.	They were ready.	They will be ready.
We are students.	We were students.	We will be students.
The clothes are ironed.	The clothes were ironed.	The clothes will be ironed.
The clothes are torn.	The clothes were torn.	The clothes will be torn.
The glass is broken.	The glass was broken.	The glass will be broken.
The food is spoiled.	The food was spoiled.	The food will be spoiled.
The food is cooked.	The food was cooked.	The food will be cooked.
The chilies are ground.	The chilies were ground.	The chilies will be ground.
The clothes are scattered.	The clothes were scattered.	The clothes will be scattered.

Lesson 3: Positive, Negative and Question

Present

Positive: She is happy.

Negative: She is not happy.

Question: Is she happy?

Negative Question: Is she not happy?

Past

Positive: She was happy.

Negative: She was not happy.

Question: Was she happy?

Negative Question: Was she not happy?

Future

Positive: She will be happy.

Negative: She will not be happy.

Question: Will she be happy?

Negative Question: Will she not be happy?

Remember: In questions, the helping/to-be verb comes before the subject.

Lesson 4: Practice

A. Complete the sentences.

1. I ____ happy. (Present)
2. I ____ happy. (Past)
3. I ____ happy. (Future)
4. Mother ____ at home. (Present)
5. Mother ____ at home. (Past)
6. Mother ____ at home. (Future)

B. Change into the other two tenses.

1. The glass is broken. → Past: _____ → Future: _____
2. The food was cooked. → Present: _____ → Future: _____
3. The clothes will be torn. → Present: _____ → Past: _____

C. Make negative sentences.

1. She is happy. → _____
2. She was happy. → _____
3. She will be happy. → _____

D. Make questions.

1. They are ready. → _____
2. They were ready. → _____
3. They will be ready. → _____

Lesson 5: Quick Review

Remember these three forms:

Present — She is happy.

Past — She was happy.

Future — She will be happy.

Key pattern

Present: Subject + am/is/are + Complement

Past: Subject + was/were + Complement

Future: Subject + will be + Complement

Your goal

Read the examples aloud. Compare the same sentence in Present, Past and Future. Then make your own sentences.

Practise a few sentences every day.

End of Book 1